Bow Valley College

Course Outline

HCAD1407

Special Activities for Clients with Various Health Conditions
Winter 2026 - Current

Last Updated: 12/17/2025 11:35:52 AM

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Bow Valley College is situated in Treaty 7 territory. We honour the territories and Peoples of: the Blackfoot Confederacy, which includes the Siksika, Kainai, Piikani, and Amskapi Piikani (Blackfeet) First Nations; the Tsuut'ina First Nation; and the Îyâxe Nakoda, which includes the Goodstoney, Chiniki, and Bearspaw First Nations. We also acknowledge the historical Northwest Métis homeland and the Otipemisiwak Métis Government of Alberta, districts 4, 5, and 6 in Battle River territory.

HCAD1407 Special Activities for Clients with Various Health Conditions

COURSE DESCRIPTION

A central feature of this course is the extensive section on meeting the care and comfort needs of clients with a diagnosis of dementia. Learners also learn about care strategies for assisting other diverse client groups such as clients with a mental health diagnosis and clients with developmental delays and physical disabilities. Health care aides employed by home care agencies may have the opportunity to provide care for infants and children, as well as caring for clients living with life-limiting illness, and who could benefit from hospice, palliative and end-of-life care. This course provides the information and skills needed to assist with these care assignments. Bow Valley College is licensed to deliver this course as part of the Government of Alberta Health Care Aide Provincial Curriculum 2019.

REQUISITES	Complete the following courses: • HCAD1405 - Clinical Placement Experience I (3)
EQUIVALENTS	None
CREDITS	5
HOURS	75
ELIGIBLE FOR PLAR	Yes
ZERO TEXTBOOK COST	No

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOMES

Bow Valley College is committed to ensuring our graduates can demonstrate their abilities in key areas that will make them effective citizens and encourage their development as lifelong students. In addition to the discipline-specific skills that students acquire in their programs, the College has identified ten learning outcomes.

College-Wide Outcomes:

1. Communication
2. Thinking Skills
3. Numeracy and Financial Literacy
4. Working with Others
5. Digital Literacy

6. Positive Attitudes and Behaviours
7. Continuous Learning
8. Health and Wellness Awareness
9. Citizenship and Intercultural Competence
10. Environmental Sustainability

#	COURSE LEARNING OUTCOME(S)	COLLEGE WIDE OUTCOMES SUPPORTED
1	Integrate knowledge of human growth and development with the care needs of infants, children, and clients with physical disabilities and developmental delays, mental health and addictive disorders and palliative and end-of-life care.	2,4,6,8
2	Integrate knowledge and examine dementia in relation to the following: • Responsive behaviours • Impact on families Role of the collaborative care team	1,2,4,6,7,8
3	Examine mental health and addictive disorders in relation to the following: • Causes • General signs and symptoms • Common treatments Impact on families and society	1,2,4,6,7,8
4	Describe key elements of the palliative care approach that can be applied to the care planning and provision of person-centred care as part of the collaborative care team to support clients.	1,2,4,6,7,8
5	Analyze own personal feelings and experiences as they relate to the following: • Clients with dementia • Clients with mental health and addictive disorders • Clients with physical disabilities and developmental delays • Clients receiving palliative care and at the end of life Meeting care needs at the time of death (post-mortem care)	1,2,4,6,7,8
6	Examine the HCA role and responsibilities across the acute and continuing care settings (home care, long-term care, and supportive living) when applying the person-centred care principles and following the care plan for the following: • Infants • Children • Clients with dementia • Clients with mental health and addictive disorders • Clients with physical disabilities and developmental delays Clients receiving palliative care and at the end of life	1,2,4,6,7,8
7	Examine cultural competence and diversity in the provision of care to the following: • Infants • Children • Clients with dementia • Clients with mental health and addictive disorders • Clients with physical disabilities and developmental delays Clients in palliative care and at the end of life	1,2,4,6,7,8,9
8	Apply knowledge of client, personal, and environmental safety when providing care to the following: • Clients with dementia • Clients with mental health and addictive disorders • Clients with physical disabilities and developmental delays Clients in palliative care and at the end of life	1,2,4,6,7,8,9
9	Demonstrate competence (knowledge, skills, behaviours, and attitudes) by applying evidence-informed practice and guidelines, such as de-escalation training, when providing individualized care to the following: • Clients with dementia • Clients with mental health and addictive disorders Clients in palliative care and at the end of life	1,2,4,6,7,8,9
10	Apply communication techniques and strategies that support person-centred care and the collaborative team to a variety of situations/scenarios with the	1,2,4,6,7,8,9

	following: • Clients with dementia • Clients with mental health and addictive disorders • Clients with physical disabilities and developmental delays Clients in palliative care and at the end of life	

COURSE MODULES AND SCHEDULE

**Course schedule subject to change, depending on delivery mode and term of study. For exact dates, please consult the Course Offering Information in Brightspace.*

WEEK/HOURS	MODULES
Week 1	Module 1: Assisting with the Care of Infants/Module 2: Assisting with the Child
Week 2	Module 3: Care for Clients with a Diagnosis of Dementia
Week 3	Module 3: Care for Clients with a Diagnosis of Dementia
Week 4	Module 3: Care for Clients with a Diagnosis of Dementia/Module 4: Caring for Clients with a Mental Health Diagnosis
Week 5	Module 4: Caring for Clients with a Mental Health Diagnosis
Week 6	Module 5: Assisting Clients with Physical Disabilities and Developmental Delays
Week 7	Reading Week (dates may vary)
Week 8	Module 6: Palliative and End-of-Life Care/Module 7: Meeting Care Preceding and Following Death/Consolidation Lab
Week 9	Consolidation Lab
Week 10	Final Exam

ASSESSMENT

COURSE LEARNING OUTCOME(S)	ASSESSMENT	WEIGHT
1-10	Final Exam	100%
1-10	Completion of Lab Skills	Pass/Fail

Important: For details on each assignment and exam, please see the Course Offering Information.

PERFORMANCE STANDARDS

A minimum grade of D is required to pass this course. However, a program may require a higher grade in this course to progress in the program or to meet specific program completion requirements.

As per the Government of Alberta Health Care Aide Provincial Curriculum and Licensing Policies, learners are required to achieve a minimum grade of B- (70%) to pass all theory and lab courses, including this course. As well, in courses HCAD1401, HCAD1403, HCAD1404, HCAD1406, and HCAD1407 learners must achieve a "pass" on all lab skills outlined in the Lab Skills Guide.

Please consult with the program area or contact the program chair for further details. A minimum Grade Point Average of 2.0 is required for graduation.

GRADING SCHEME

Grade	Percentage	Grade Point	Description
A+	95-100	4.0	Exceptional: superior knowledge of subject matter
A	90-94	4.0	Excellent: outstanding knowledge of subject matter
A-	85-89	3.67	
B+	80-84	3.33	
B	75-79	3.0	Very Good: knowledge of subject matter generally mastered
B-	70-74	2.67	
C+	67-69	2.33	
C	64-66	2.0	Satisfactory/Acceptable: knowledge of subject matter adequately mastered
C-	60-63	1.67	
D+	57-59	1.33	
D	50-56	1.0	Minimal Pass
F	Less than 50	0.0	Fail: an unsatisfactory performance

REQUIRED LEARNING RESOURCES

Government of Alberta. (2019). *Health care aide provincial curriculum learner guide: Course 7 special activities for clients with various health conditions*. Edmonton, AB.

(A digital copy is available in Brightspace, or a printed copy can be purchased at the bookstore.)

Government of Alberta. (2019). *Health care aide provincial curriculum lab skills guide courses 1, 3, 4, 6 and 7*. Edmonton, AB.

(A digital copy is available in Brightspace, or a printed copy can be purchased at the bookstore.)

Sorrentino, S., Remmert, L., Wilk, M., Newmaster, R. (2021). Sorrentino's Canadian Textbook for the Support Worker– Text, Workbook and Clinical Skills: Skills for Nurse Assisting. (5th Canadian ed.) Toronto: Elsevier Canada or current edition. (ISBN: 9780323880626)

OR

Sorrentino's Canadian Textbook for the Support Worker Elsevier eBook on VitalSource, 5th Cdn. (Purchase on the Evolve site. The ISBN is: 9780323711661)

Canadian Clinical Skills: Skills for Personal Support Workers, 1st Cdn Edition by Elsevier

Additional learning resources may be found in the Course Offering Information or in Brightspace.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Bow Valley College is licensed to deliver this course as part of the Government of Alberta Health Care Aide Provincial Curriculum 2019.

Additional Resources:

Abe's Garden Community. [Abe's Garden Community]. (2019, October 1). *Mealtime tips for persons with dementia*. [Video]. YouTube. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=tujTZK0s804&t=264s

Agnelli, J., & Mitchell, G. (2014, September 4). Person-centred care for people with dementia: Kitwood Reconsidered. *Nursing Standard, 30(7), pp. 46-50*. Retrieved from https://www.researchgate.net/publication/283244999_Person-centred_care_for_people_with_dementia_Kitwood_reconsidered/link/5666aa2508ae192bbf928b58/download

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Alberta Government. (2017, November 6). *Opioids and substance misuse among First Nations People in Alberta*. Retrieved November 28, 2021, from https://open.alberta.ca/publications/opioids-and-substances-of-misuse-among-first-nations-people-in-alberta

Alberta Government. (2018, April). Alberta Health Care Aide Competency Profile. Retrieved November 28, 2021 from https://open.alberta.ca/dataset/e1fbd562-1571-40b8-bc17-71687dab444c/resource/9e34d246-c389-4753-bda4-f53a77e02f80/download/ah-hca-corecompetency-profile-2018.pdf

Alberta Government. (2018, December 11). *Alberta opioid response surveillance report: 2018 Q3*. Alberta Health. Retrieved November 28, 2021 from https://www.alberta.ca/assets/documents/opioid-substances-misuse-report-2018-q3.pdf

Alberta Government. (2018, August 29). *New opioid crisis supports for Indigenous People*. Alberta Health. Retrieved November 28, 2021, from https://www.alberta.ca/release.cfm?xID=5853540C34502-9788-91F6-CD91F84EB23ACCF6

Alberta Government. (2019). *Health care aide provincial curriculum: Course 1 Health care aide roles and responsibilities Module 2: Legislation*. Edmonton, AB

Alberta Government. (2019). *Health care aide provincial curriculum: Course 1 Health care aide roles and responsibilities Module 3: Functioning effectively as a team member*. Edmonton, AB

Alberta Government. (2019). *Health care aide provincial curriculum: Course 1 Health care aide roles and responsibilities Module 6: Self-Care and Safety*. Edmonton, AB

Alberta Government. (2019). *Health care aide provincial curriculum: Course 7 Module 1 Assisting with the Care of Infants*. Edmonton, AB

Alberta Government. (2019). *Health care aide provincial curriculum: Course 7 Module 2 Assisting with the child*. Edmonton, AB

Alberta Government (2021). *How can I help?* Retrieved November 28, 2021 from http://www.humanservices.alberta.ca/abuse-bullying/15393.html

Alberta Government. (2021). *Alberta's challenge*. Retrieved November 28, 2021 from http://www.humanservices.alberta.ca/homelessness/14602.html

Alberta Government. (2021) *Alberta's opioid crisis response*. Alberta Health. Retrieved November 28,2021 from https://www.alberta.ca/alberta-opioid-crisis-response.aspx

Alberta Government. (2021). *Alberta statistics on homelessness*. Retrieved November 28, 2021 from http://www.humanservices.alberta.ca/homelessness/16052.html

Alberta Government. (2021) *Harm reduction*. Retrieved November 28, 2021 from https://www.alberta.ca/opioid-harm-reduction.aspx

Alberta Government. (2021). *Advance care planning*: *Preparing for your future healthcare*. Retrieved November 28, 2021, from https://myhealth.alberta.ca/HealthTopics/Advance-Care-Planning

Alberta Government. (2021). *Personal directive*. Retrieved November 28, 2021, from https://www.alberta.ca/personal-directive.aspx

Alberta Government. (2021). *Powers of Attorney Act*. Retrieved November 28, 2021, from http://www.qp.alberta.ca/1266.cfm?page=p20.cfm&leg_type=Acts&isbncln=9780779786404&display=html

Alberta Government. (2021). *Service types*. Retrieved November 28, 2021, from https://myhealth.alberta.ca/palliative-care/what-is-it/service-types

Alberta Government. (2021, August 18). *Dementia*. Retrieved November 28, 2021 from https://myhealth.alberta.ca/Health/pages/conditions.aspx?Hwid=uf4984.

Alberta Government. (2021, June 17). *Province of Alberta mental health act*. Retrieved November 30, 2021, from https://www.qp.alberta.ca/documents/Acts/M13.pdf

Alberta Health Services. (2014, October 9). *Meeting the needs of people living with dementia in Alberta's residential living options ensuring person-centred care*. Retrieved November 28, 2021 from https://www.albertahealthservices.ca/assets/info/seniors/if-sen-dementia-care-in-residential-settings.pdf

Alberta Health Services. (2015, June). *Health care and religious beliefs* (2nd ed.). Retrieved November 28, 2021 from https://www.albertahealthservices.ca/assets/programs/ps-1026227-health-care-religious-beliefs.pdf

Alberta Health Services. (2017, August). *Medical assistance in dying – What are my end-of-life options?* Retrieved November 28, 2021, from https://www.albertahealthservices.ca/assets/info/hp/maid/if-hp-maid-end-of-life-options.pdf

Alberta Health Services. (2019). *Spiritual health practitioners*. Retrieved November 8, 2021, from https://www.albertahealthservices.ca/info/Page15763.aspx

Alberta Health Services. (2021). *Addiction and mental health*. Retrieved November 28, 2021 from https://www.albertahealthservices.ca/amh/amh.aspx

Alberta Health Services. (2021). *Appropriate use of antipsychotics (aua) toolkit*. Retrieved November 8, 2021, from https://www.albertahealthservices.ca/scns/auatoolkit.aspx

Alberta Health Services. (2021). *Get Naloxone*. Retrieved November 28, 2021 from https://www.albertahealthservices.ca/info/page15586.aspx

Alberta Health Services. (2021). *Harm reduction*. Retrieved November 28, 2021 from https://www.albertahealthservices.ca/info/Page15432.aspx

Alberta Health Services. (2021). *Mental Health Act. Information for Health Professionals*. Retrieved November 8, 2021, from https://www.albertahealthservices.ca/info/mha.aspx

Alzheimer Society of Canada. (2017, April). *How does pain affect people with dementia?* Retrieved November 28, 2021, from https://alzheimer.ca/sites/default/files/files/national/for-hcp/hcp_pain_e.pdf

Alzheimer's Society of Canada. (2018). *Dementia, intimacy and sexuality*. November 28, 2021, from https://alzheimer.ca/sites/default/files/files/national/brochures-conversations/conversations_intimacy-and-sexuality.pdf?utm_medium=301&utm_source=alzheimer.ca

Alzheimer Society of Canada. (2021). *Decision-making and Respecting Independence*. Retrieved November 28, 2021 from https://alzheimer.ca/en/help-support/im-caring-person-living-dementia/providing-day-day-care/decision-making-respecting

Alzheimer Society of Canada. (2021). *How to get tested for Dementia*. Retrieved November 28,2021 from https://alzheimer.ca/en/Home/About-dementia/Diagnosis

Alzheimer Society of Canada. (2021). *I'm Living with Dementia*. Retrieved November 28, 2021, from https://alzheimer.ca/en/help-support/im-living-dementia

Alzheimer Society of Canada. (2021). *Myths and realities of Alzheimer's disease*. Retrieved November 28, 2021, from https://alzheimer.ca/en/Home/About-dementia/Alzheimer-s-disease/Myth-and-reality-about-Alzheimer-s-disease

Alzheimer Society of Canada. (2021). *Restlessness or Sundowning*. Retrieved November 28, 2021, from https://alzheimer.ca/en/help-support/im-caring-person-living-dementia/understanding-symptoms/restlessness-or-sundowning

Alzheimer Society of Canada. (2021). *Tough issues: Using Restraints*. Retrieved November 28, 2021, from https://alzheimer.ca/en/help-support/im-caring-person-living-dementia/ensuring-safety-security/using-restraints

Alzheimer Society of Canada. (2021). *What is Dementia?* Retrieved November 28, 2021, from https://alzheimer.ca/en/Home/About-dementia/What-is-dementia

Alzheimer Society of Canada. (2021). *Video Resources*. Retrieved November 30, 2021, from https://alzheimer.ca/en/help-support/dementia-resources/video-resources

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Canadian Mental Health Association. (2009). *Mental health*. Retrieved November 28, 2021 from https://cmha.ca/find-info/mental-health/

Canadian Psychological Association. (2015). *"Psychology works" fact sheet: Cognitive disorders and dementia*. Retrieved November 28, 2021 from https://cpa.ca/docs/File/Publications/FactSheets/PsychologyWorksFactSheet_CognitiveDisordersAndDementia.pdf

Crisisprevention. [Crisis Prevention Institute]. (2010, December 16). *De-escalation Techniques*. [Video]. YouTube. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=pBe4A32fpyI

Crisis Prevention Institute. (2020, 15 October). CPI's top 10 de-escalation tips. [Web log message]. Retrieved November 28, 2021 from https://www.crisisprevention.com/en-CA/Blog/October-2017/CPI-s-Top-10-De-Escalation-Tips-Revisited

Government of Alberta. (2013). *Health care aide provincial curriculum: Course 7 Module 3 Caring for clients with a diagnosis of dementia*. Edmonton, AB

Government of Alberta. (2013). *Health care aide provincial curriculum: Course 7 Module 4 caring for clients with a mental health diagnosis*. Edmonton, AB

Government of Alberta. (2013). *Health care aide provincial curriculum: Course 7 Module 5 assisting clients with physical disabilities and developmental delays.* Edmonton, AB

Government of Alberta. (2013). *Health care aide provincial curriculum: Course 7 Module 6 End-of-life care.* Edmonton, AB

Government of Alberta. (2013). *Health care aide provincial curriculum: Course 7 Module 7 Meeting care needs at the time of death.* Edmonton, AB

Government of Alberta. (2013). *How can I help?* Retrieved from http://www.humanservices.alberta.ca/abuse-bullying/15393.html

Government of British Columbia. (2013, March). *The provincial end-of-life care action plan for British Columbia*. Retrieved November 28, 2021 from https://www.health.gov.bc.ca/library/publications/year/2013/end-of-life-care-action-plan.pdf

Government of Canada. (2021, June 11). Delivering on truth and reconciliation commission calls to action. Retrieved November 30, 2021, from https://www.rcaanc-cirnac.gc.ca/eng/1524494530110/1557511412801

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Hodgson, H. (2015, June 22). What is compassion fatigue? [Web log message]. Retrieved November 28, 2021 from https://thecaregiverspace.org/what-is-compassion-fatigue/

Khan, S. (2019). *Aboriginal mental health: The statistical reality*. Retrieved November 28, 2021 from http://www.heretohelp.bc.ca/visions/aboriginal-people-vol5/aboriginal-mental-health-the-statistical-reality

Kwong, A. [Elizz]. (2017, January 13). Dementia and Memory Loss - Caregiver Tips. [Video]. YouTube. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=nl4BjQMgZSA

Memory Bridge: The Foundation for Alzheimer's and Cultural Memory. [Memorybridge]. (2007). *Gladys Wilson and Naomi Feil*. [Video]. YouTube. https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CrZXz10FcVM&feature=youtu.be

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Oxford University Press. (2021). *Definition of de-escalation*. Retrieved November 28, 2021 from https://en.oxforddictionaries.com/definition/de-escalation.

Oxford University Press. (2018). *Definition of situation*. Retrieved from https://en.oxforddictionaries.com/definition/situation

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World Health Organization. (2021, June 17). *Suicide*. Retrieved November 28, 2021, from https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/suicide

World Health Organization. (2021). *WHO definition of palliative care*. Retrieved November 28, 2021, from https://www.who.int/cancer/palliative/definition/en/

Additional information may be found in the Course Offering Information or in Brightspace.

ACADEMIC ACCOMMODATIONS

Students with documented disabilities (e.g., mental health diagnosis, learning disability, physical disability, etc.) may qualify for classroom and/or exam accommodations. The College can also assist students who may be experiencing difficulties with learning but do not have a formal diagnosis. Students who need academic and exam accommodations based on other protected grounds may also make those requests.
It is the student's responsibility to request academic accommodations. Students are encouraged to contact Accessibility Services as early as possible.

Visit: Learner Success Services- 1st floor south campus
Contact: accessibility@bowvalleycollege.ca or 403-410-1440
BVC Central: Accessibility Services

INSTITUTIONAL POLICIES

Bow Valley College is committed to the highest standards of academic integrity and honesty. Students are urged to become familiar with and uphold the following policies: Academic Integrity (500-1-7), Student Code of Conduct (500-1-1), Student Appeals (500-1-12), Attendance (500-1- 10), Grading (500-1-6), Academic Continuance and Graduation (500-1-5), and Electronic Communications (300-2-13).
Audio or video recording of lectures, labs, seminars, or any other teaching and learning environment by students is allowed only with consent of the instructor as part of an approved accommodation plan. Recorded material is to be used solely for personal study and is not being used or distributed without prior written consent from the instructor.

Academic Integrity:

At Bow Valley College, we value academic integrity. This means everyone at the college, including students, faculty, and staff, follow principles that foster ethical and truthful ways of being in their work

and studies. The college is committed to integrity being infused in all aspects of work and studies. It is important to act with integrity in everything you do at the college. The values you practice at the college are the same values that will inform and guide your career. If someone breaks from the principles that are in agreement with academic integrity policy, the college is committed to carefully investigating and fairly handling any issues related to academic integrity and academic misconduct.

Academic misconduct is acting in such a way as to give yourself or others an unfair academic advantage or disadvantage. Examples of this can include:

- Plagiarism
- Cheating on tests or exams
- Tampering with or falsifying any grades or documents
- Sharing assignments or exam information with others
- Aiding others in dishonest acts
- Using artificial intelligence in graded work without the explicit consent of the instructor
- Recording anything in the classroom or other instructional area without permission

Breaking from the principles that guide academic integrity can lead to educative interventions and/or punitive measures. It is the student's responsibility to review the Academic Integrity Policy. Please review the following resources:

- Academic Integrity Policy Summary
- Academic Integrity Policy
- Academic Integrity Procedure

Turnitin:

Students may be required to submit their course work to Turnitin, a third-party service provider engaged by BVC. Turnitin identifies plagiarism by checking databases of electronic books and articles, archived webpages, and previously submitted student work. Students acknowledge that any course work or essays submitted to Turnitin will be included as source documents in the Turnitin.com reference database, where it will be used solely to detect plagiarism. The terms that apply to a student's use of Turnitin are described on Turnitin.com.

Online Exam Proctoring:

Examinations for this course may require proctoring through an online proctoring service. Online proctoring enables online exam taking within a controlled and monitored environment, thereby enhancing academic integrity. Online proctoring may occur through a variety of methods, including but not limited to:

a. live online proctoring where either the course instructor, a representative of Bow Valley College, or a remote invigilator authenticates identity and observes completion of an exam using specialized software and recordings;
b. automated proctoring where the exam session is recorded and AI (artificial intelligence) analyzed;

c. browser lockdown that limits access to other applications, websites, copying, printing, screen capture and other functions; or
d. a combination of both live/automated proctoring and browser lockdown.

Course instructors will review recordings, analyses, and data obtained through online proctoring for academic integrity infractions. It is the student's responsibility to meet the technical, software, location, and identity verification requirements necessary to enable online proctoring.

Further details of these policies are available in the Academic Calendar and on the Bow Valley College website, https://www.bowvalleycollege.ca/academic-calendar.
Students are encouraged to keep a copy of this course outline for future reference.

Collection of Personal Information:

This course, including your image and voice, may be recorded and made available to you and other students taking the course. By attending the class(es) online or in person, you consent to the collection of your personal information. If you do not wish to be recorded, please contact your instructor before starting the course/class to discuss alternative arrangements. You may use the recordings only for educational purposes. You must not copy, share, or use the recordings for any other purpose without the instructor's express permission. Your personal information is collected in accordance with section 4 (c) of the Protection of Privacy Act, Alberta (POPA) to deliver academic programming, support student flexibility, promote universal design for learning principles, and for purposes consistent with the course activities and outcomes. Bow Valley College uses automated systems to generate content and make decisions, recommendations and predictions, and your personal information may be included in these automated systems.
Your personal information will be used and disclosed in accordance with sections 12 and 13 of POPA and protected in accordance with section 10 of POPA. If you have any questions about the collection, use, disclosure or protection of personal information, please contact the Access and Privacy Officer at privacy@bowvalleycollege.ca.